

BENJAMIN GRAHAM

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Senior Property Manager | Operations, Compliance and AI Adoption

PROFILE

Senior Property Manager and AI Development Lead running a 511-unit, 20-development leasehold portfolio and a team of four for a RICS-regulated chartered surveying firm, with over a decade across property, estates and facilities management. Leads a compliance programme covering fire safety, asbestos, legionella and building safety legislation, owns service charge budgets of around £1.3 million and directs capital and cyclical works, including heritage roof replacements of up to £450,000. Directed the move from paper-based to digital-first invoicing and led evaluation of a replacement management platform, alongside a self-initiated, firm-wide AI adoption programme covering strategy, governance, data protection documentation and staff training. Experienced in contractor and supplier management, stakeholder relations and turning regulatory requirements into workable operational process.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Statutory compliance and health and safety (fire, asbestos, legionella, building safety)
- Budget ownership and financial control
- Contractor and supplier management
- Team leadership and staff development
- Stakeholder and resident relationship management
- Governance and company secretarial support
- AI strategy, adoption and staff training
- Capital and cyclical works delivery

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Property Manager and AI Development Lead, ASH Chartered Surveyors (ASH & Co. CS LLP), Cheltenham

March 2024 to present

- Manages a 511-unit leasehold portfolio across 20 developments in Gloucestershire, including new-build, heritage and Grade II listed properties, for a RICS-regulated chartered surveying firm.
- Leads a team of four assistant and junior property managers.
- Directs statutory compliance across fire safety, asbestos, legionella and building safety, and runs Section 20 major works consultations (Landlord and Tenant Act 1985), including heritage roof replacement projects of £250,000 to £450,000.
- Delivered the full external redecoration of Shaftesbury Hall, a Grade II listed building (in excess of £80,000), and the full replacement of external guttering and soil and vent pipes at Glencairn Court (£25,000).
- Owns service charge budgets of approximately £1.3 million across the portfolio, including administration and reconciliation, and directs cyclical works and long-term reserve planning.
- Supports resident management and right to manage boards on governance and director duties; convenes and runs AGMs and resident meetings for RMC boards and resolves disputes.
- Selects and manages contractors and suppliers and reviews their performance; liaises with leaseholders, local authorities, planning officers and Historic England.
- Replaced paper-based invoicing with a digital-first process and led evaluation of a replacement management platform, consolidating invoicing, work order tracking and compliance data.

AI Development Lead, ASH Chartered Surveyors (self-initiated; now part of the formal role title)

- Designed and delivered a firm-wide rollout of an enterprise AI platform, including a five-seat pilot, and produced an AI adoption strategy report presented to senior partners.
- Produced data protection documentation including a record of processing activities, a legitimate interests assessment and a data protection impact assessment.
- Built a staff training pack, facilitator scripts and an onboarding tracker, and established a verification framework governing checking of AI-assisted outputs.

- Delivered four production tools now in daily use across the team, supporting statutory documentation, governance correspondence, house style and compliance work.
- Built cost and usage reporting into the tooling so running costs are attributed per workflow and reviewed against the time they save.
- Developed and operates a voice-and-photo property inspection application replacing paper-based inspections, with AI-assisted classification and automated report generation. Live since May 2026; 127 inspections completed and 99 reports generated in the field, replacing a process that previously took about two hours of write-up per inspection.

Independent Practice, Cheltenham

January 2024 to present

- Built and maintains a conversational booking system for a small business client, replacing manual phone and email enquiries, with an admin dashboard and automated confirmations.
- Contracted separately by ASH Chartered Surveyors to deliver drone surveys of building facades and roofs in the CAA Open category (A1), with AI-assisted survey report generation.

Estate Manager, Mainstay Facilities Management, Century Court, Cheltenham

October 2020 to March 2024

- Managed estate operations, contractor oversight and safe systems of work for a large private residential development, and was main point of contact for residents on building fabric and major works requirements.
- Handled service queries and grievances, including obligations under the site's Section 106 agreement, and kept fire and legionella risk assessments and business continuity plans under review.
- Managed the facilities management and wider estate budgets, and led on-site capital projects including lift replacement, external lighting upgrade and roof replacement.

Career break, January to October 2020. Had accepted a role in Australia; the relocation and the post were cancelled when borders closed under COVID-19.

Facilities General Manager, Derwent Facilities Management, Pittville Student Village, Cheltenham

July 2019 to January 2020

- Led the on-site FM team across hard and soft services, managing performance against service levels and KPIs, and was main point of contact for community representatives on grievances and service performance under s106 obligations.
- Managed the FM contract, sourced best return on site and external contractor spend, and trained operatives to industry cleaning standards company-wide.

Soft Services Manager, Derwent Facilities Management, Pittville Student Village, Cheltenham

July 2017 to July 2019

- Held client-side responsibility for all soft services and led the site's initial mobilisation, including recruitment and team build, and implemented new safe systems of work and electronic visitor management.

Earlier security and accommodation roles, Cheltenham and Gloucester, 2011 to 2017

Security and accommodation roles for Sodexo Facilities Management, Uliving/Derwent Facilities Management, Gloucestershire Security Services and Octaga Security Solutions: site security, access control and compliance with client audit regimes including BRC and WCM.

EDUCATION AND QUALIFICATIONS

- LBICSc Trainer/Assessor, British Institute of Cleaning Science, 2019.
- Facilities Management Diploma, New Skills Academy, 2019.
- IOSH Managing Safely, 2019.
- TPI (The Property Institute, formerly IRPM): Level 3 study pack completed; Associate membership application submitted 2026.
- The Open University: two years of undergraduate study completed (Computing and IT; Business Management).
- NVQ National Diploma, Uniformed Public Services, Gloucestershire College (Merit).

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- UAV operator in the CAA Open category (A1); maintains a public open-source library of AI workflow tooling.
- Board and committee member, Oddfellows North Gloucestershire lodge: contributes to oversight of the lodge's property portfolio and strategic planning; also Social Media Development Officer.
- Full clean driving licence.